



Handout 6.10: Dish Research Card and Comparison

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Print pages 1 to 4 for every student. Page 5 is the research packet reading option for classes without devices. Page 6 is the grade 8 stretch card.

Our class agreement on food talk

Read it before you write anything.

1. **Curious, not disgusted.** “I have not tried that” is a sentence. “That is gross” is not.
2. **Ask, do not assume.** If you want to know why a food is made a certain way, ask the question instead of guessing the answer.
3. **No ranking.** No best cuisine, no worst, no “weird.” Different climates and different crops made different food. That is the whole explanation.
4. **Nobody has to be the expert on their own background.** You may share a family dish if you want to, and you may say nothing, and neither one gets a follow-up question.

Part 1. The five factors that shape a cuisine

Factor	What it means	One example from today
Climate		
Crops		
Trade		
Migration		
Religion		

Which factor do you think matters most? _____ Why?



Part 2. Pick your form and your three cultures

Circle one form. Your group takes all three dishes inside it, one per person.

Form	Culture 1	Culture 2	Culture 3	Fourth option
Filled dough	Empanada (Latin America and Spain)	Pierogi (Poland)	Samosa (South Asia)	Jiaozi (China) or ravioli (Italy)
Rice and beans plate	Rice and peas (Jamaica)	Gallo pinto (Costa Rica and Nicaragua)	Red beans and rice (Louisiana)	Hoppin' john (the Carolinas)
Flatbread	Pita (eastern Mediterranean)	Roti or chapati (South Asia)	Tortilla (Mexico and Central America)	Injera (Ethiopia and Eritrea) or lavash (Armenia and Turkey)

My form: _____ My dish: _____

Part 3. My research card

Fill in all five boxes. You need two sources and one of them must be a library source or a reference source, not a search result summary.

Box	My answer
1. Region and country or countries	
2. Main ingredients (four or five)	
3. Cooking method (from the Lesson 6.6 list: bake, roast, broil, toast, sauté, boil, simmer, steam, poach)	
4. Why here? Name a crop, a climate, a trade route, a migration, or a religious practice that explains why this dish exists in this place. “Because it is their tradition” does not answer this.	
5. One thing that will surprise the class	

My two sources

#	Source title	Author or publisher	Type (book, encyclopedia, museum, university, news, other)
1			
2			

My ninety-second presentation, in order

1. My dish is _____ from _____.
2. The main ingredients are _____.
3. It is cooked by _____.
4. It exists there because _____.
5. The thing that surprised me is _____.

Part 4. The comparison

Fill this in as you hear the other two dishes in your form.

	Dish 1: _____	Dish 2: _____	Dish 3: _____
Region			
Main ingredients			
Cooking method			
What makes it different from the other two			

What is the same across all three?





What is different?





Why is it different? Name at least two of the five factors.

Factor 1: _____ How it explains a difference: _____



Factor 2: _____ How it explains a difference: _____



The last line

One thing I would try: _____

One question I still have: _____

Exit card, Day 1

The factor that explains my dish best is _____ because _____



If we are not tasting: the extension task

Pick a **fourth** everyday form that shows up in at least three cultures. Name the form and the three versions. You may not use one of the three on the list above.

My fourth form: _____

Culture	The name of the dish there	One ingredient that makes it local
1.		
2.		
3.		

One sentence on why this form shows up everywhere:



Page 5: Research packet reading option

For classes without devices. Print two short paragraphs and one photo per dish from a library source. Below is what each paragraph needs to contain so students can complete the card.

Each printed paragraph must give	Because the card asks for
The country or region, and whether the dish travels beyond it	Box 1
Four or five main ingredients by name	Box 2
How it is cooked, in words a student can match to the nine methods	Box 3
One fact about the local crop, the climate, a trade route, a migration, or a religious practice	Box 4
The source title, author or publisher, and date, printed at the bottom of the page	The two source lines

Page 6: Grade 8 stretch card

Three sources, one of them printed. Then answer this.

Pick one ingredient in your dish. Trace it back to where the **plant** actually came from, and explain how it got to your dish's region.

Question	My answer
The ingredient	
Where the plant originally came from	
How it got to my dish's region (trade, colonization, migration, or deliberate planting)	
About when	
My source for this	

The hard question: based on what you found, is there such a thing as a pure traditional cuisine? Answer in three or four sentences, using your ingredient as the evidence.





